

Staged Urethroplasty (Two-Stage Repair)

Patient Information · Rebuilding the urethra in two operations, months apart

WARWIKI

Some narrowings of the urethra are too long or too scarred to fix in one operation. A staged urethroplasty rebuilds the urethra in **two operations**, usually **at least 4 to 6 months apart**. The first lays down new lining, often from inside your cheek. The second rolls it into a tube. The **WARWIKI urethroplasty** and **cheek graft** handouts explain the basics.

About This Procedure

- **First stage.** The narrow part of the urethra is opened along its underside and left open to the skin. Scar is removed. A patch of cheek lining (a **graft**) is often stitched in to make a new, healthy strip. Urine then comes out of a **new opening** farther back on the penis, or behind the scrotum.
- **Healing time.** The graft heals and softens. Your team checks that the strip is healthy and wide enough. Some people need a touch-up or more graft first.
- **Second stage.** The healed strip is rolled into a tube around a catheter and covered with a layer of tissue. The skin is closed.

Benefits and Risks in Numbers

about
9 in 10

had an open urethra with no more treatment about 4 years after both stages

about
1 in 6

needed an extra operation on the first stage before it could be closed

more than
9 in 10

were satisfied with the result. Erections were usually unchanged

Numbers come mainly from one study of 100 people. Your own risk may differ; ask your team.

Living Between Stages

- **Sit down to urinate.** The new opening is farther back, so the stream can spray or dribble when you stand.
- A dressing protects the graft for about the first week. After that, keep the area clean and follow your team's washing instructions.
- Wait for your team's OK before sex.
- Tell your team if the stream starts to spray more or gets weaker. The opening may be narrowing.

Learn the Terms

Urethra

The tube that carries urine out of the body.

Stricture

A scarred, narrow part of the urethra that slows the urine stream.

Urethroplasty

Surgery to repair and rebuild the urethra.

Graft

A patch of your own tissue, often from inside the cheek, moved to rebuild the urethra.

Lichen sclerosus

A skin condition that scars the tip of the penis and the urethra.

Hypospadias

A urethral opening on the underside of the penis from birth, often repaired in childhood.

Fistula

A small hole that lets urine leak through the skin along the repair.

Urethrogram

An X-ray with dye that checks healing before the catheter comes out.

Will it hurt? You are asleep for each operation, so you feel nothing. Afterward, expect soreness and swelling for a couple of weeks, and a sore cheek if a graft was taken. Pain medicine helps. The mouth usually heals within a few weeks.

First stage Home in a day or two. A dressing and catheter for a short time.	Healing At least 4 to 6 months. Sit to urinate. Visits check the graft.	Second stage A catheter for about 2 to 3 weeks, then an X-ray before it comes out.	After that Visits for at least a year, with flow tests and a camera check.
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Why Two Operations?

Staging is used for **lichen sclerosus**, failed earlier repairs or childhood hypospadias surgery, and very long or scarred narrowings. The new lining can heal and be checked before it is closed. When one operation can do the job, a one-stage repair is preferred. Some people decide to keep the first-stage opening for good. This works like a **perineal urethrostomy**, which has its own handout.

How to Get Ready

- A **urine test** checks for infection. Any infection is treated first.
- **Stop smoking.** It slows healing.
- Tell your team about blood thinners, diabetes, skin conditions such as lichen sclerosus, and earlier urethral surgery.
- Plan for two operations and time off after each one.

After Each Operation

- Soreness, swelling and bruising are normal at first. Keep the catheter secured and do not pull on it.
- After the second stage, some **dribbling** after you finish urinating is common.
- Possible problems include a **fistula**, the wound opening, or narrowing at the tip. Some need another small operation.
- A narrowing can come back, even years later. Keep your follow-up visits.

Call the office that did your surgery if you have:

- A temperature of **100.4 °F (38 °C)** or higher, or chills
- Redness, swelling, pus or a wound that opens
- Urine leaking from a new spot along the repair, or a stream that sprays more or gets weaker

Go to an emergency department if:

- The catheter stops draining, or you cannot urinate, and your bladder feels full or painful
- Heavy bleeding that does not stop with firm pressure
- You cannot reach the office and are worried

Three Things to Remember

1. A staged repair rebuilds the urethra in two operations, months apart.
2. Between stages, urine comes out farther back. Sitting down helps.
3. A narrowing can come back, even years later. Tell your team if your stream slows.